N. Ezgi Altınışık

Assistant Professor

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Google Scholar · altinisik

Research Interests

Archaeogenomics and population history of Anatolia and the Near East; genetic kinship and social organisation in past societies; human mobility from the Neolithic to the Roman period; computational methods for ancient DNA.

Education

PhD **University of Ostrava**, Biology — Ostrava, Czechia, 2015 – 2019
- Thesis: *Bridging the Americas and Eurasia: Population history of American arctic peoples*

MSc **Istanbul University**, Molecular Biology and Genetics — Istanbul, Türkiye, 2012 – 2015

BSc **Istanbul University**, Molecular Biology and Genetics — Istanbul, Türkiye, 2007 – 2012

Academic Positions

Hacettepe University, Assistant Professor, Department of Anthropology — Ankara, Türkiye, 2024 – present

Sorbonne University, Visiting Scholar (PRESTIJ Fellowship), in collaboration with Prof. Anne-Valérie Pont — Paris, France, June 2026 – July 2026

Hacettepe University, Instructor, Department of Anthropology — Ankara, Türkiye, 2019 – 2024

Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Visiting Researcher, Department of Archaeogenetics — Jena, Germany, 2018 – 2019

University of Ostrava, Researcher, Life Science Research Center — Ostrava, Czechia, 2015 – 2019

Mustafa Kemal University, Research Assistant, Department of Anthropology — Hatay, Türkiye, 2014 – 2015

Awards and Fellowships

PRESTIJ Research Fellowship, French Embassy in Türkiye — 2026
Visiting scholar at Sorbonne University, integrating epigraphic and historical frameworks of Roman history with paleogenomics.

Science Academy Young Scientist Award (BAGEP) in Anthropology — 2025
Merit-based award providing independent funding to outstanding early-career researchers in Türkiye.

ESEB Outreach Initiative Fund — 2017
Project: A Timeline of the Human Evolutionary Tree with Actual and Replica Skulls

PhD Scholarship, University of Ostrava — 2015 – 2019

ESEB Outreach Initiative Fund — 2015
Project: The 5th Evolution, Science, and Education Symposium

Outstanding Merit Scholarship, Sabancı Foundation — 2007 – 2011

Grants and Projects

From Bones to Bonds: Building the Genomic Basis for Roman Kinship Studies — 2025 – 2027
Principal Investigator · TÜBİTAK 2247-B European Research Council (ERC) Support Program

Investigation of Bronze Age Western Anatolian Population Dynamics with Archaeogenomic Approaches 2024 – 2027
Advisor · TÜBİTAK 1001 Scientific and Technological Research Projects Funding Program

Leprosy in Anatolia: A Palaeopathological and Archaeogenomic Study 2023 – 2026
Advisor · TÜBİTAK 1001 Scientific and Technological Research Projects Funding Program

Supplementary Funding for TÜBİTAK 1001 Project 121Z485 2023 – 2025
Principal Investigator · Hacettepe University Scientific Research Projects Coordination Unit (BAP)

Nicaean People and Byzantine Warriors: A Bioarchaeological Study (İBİS) 2022 – 2025
Researcher · TÜBİTAK 1001 Scientific and Technological Research Projects Funding Program

Anatolian–Caucasian Relations from the Neolithic to the Middle Ages: An Archaeogenomic Study on Human Remains from Anatolia and Azerbaijan 2022 – 2025
Advisor · TÜBİTAK 1001 Scientific and Technological Research Projects Funding Program

Investigation of the Population History of Roman Era Coastal and Inland Societies in Anatolia from an Archaeogenomic Perspective 2021 – 2024
Principal Investigator · TÜBİTAK 1001 Scientific and Technological Research Projects Funding Program (Project No. 121Z485)

Mapping the Neolithic Expansion in the Mediterranean: A Scientific Collective to Promote Archaeogenomics and Evolutionary Biology Research in Turkey (NEOMATRIX) 2021 – 2024
Researcher · European Union Horizon 2020 Twinning

Archaeogenomic Analysis of Genetic and Cultural Interactions in Neolithic Anatolian Societies (NEOGENE) 2018 – 2024
Researcher · European Research Council (ERC) Consolidator Grant, Horizon 2020

Archaeogenetic Study of Human Populations in Mainland Southeast Asia 2019 – 2021
Research Fellow · University of Ostrava, Czechia

New Research Directions at the Life Science Research Centre 2015 – 2017
Research Fellow · University of Ostrava, Czechia

First-Author Articles

C-Turkey: A Comprehensive Radiocarbon Dataset from Türkiye Aug 2026
N. E. Altınışık
10.5334/joad.213 (Journal of Open Archaeology Data 14(17))

A Genomic Snapshot of Demographic and Cultural Dynamism in Upper Mesopotamia during the Neolithic Transition Nov 2022
N. E. Altınışık, D. D. Kazancı, A. Aydoğan, …, M. Somel
10.1126/sciadv.abo3609 (Science Advances 8(44): eabo3609)

The Fight for Evolution Nov 2022
N. E. Altınışık
10.7554/eLife.84343 (eLife 11: e84343)

Irk Kavramına Bilimsel Çerçeveden Bakış [A Scientific Perspective on the Concept of Race] 2018
N. E. Altınışık, Ö. Taşkent
(Madde, Diyalektik ve Toplum 1(3): 189–196)

Adaptif Melezlenme: Homo sapiens'in Dünyaya Yayılışındaki Etkileri [Adaptive Introgression: Its Effects on the Global Dispersal of Homo sapiens] 2016
N. E. Altınışık
(Toplum ve Hekim 31: 295–298)

Modern İnsan Popülasyonlarında Arkaik İzler [Archaic Traces in Modern Human Populations] 2016
N. E. Altınışık
(Kebikeç 20)

Co-Authored Articles

Diet and Mobility in Byzantine Western Anatolia: Carbon and Nitrogen Isotopic Ratios and Ancient DNA Evidence from Barcın Höyük and Kadıkalesi Anaia May 2026
R. Özbal, A. M. Büyükkarakaya, G. Uysal, E. Bütün, F. Gerritsen, A. Akbaba, **N. E. Altınışık**, M. Somel
10.1017/eaa.2025.10027 (European Journal of Archaeology 29(2): 202–222)

DeepKin: Predicting Relatedness from Low-Coverage Genomes and Palaeogenomes with Convolutional Neural Networks Nov 2025
M. N. Güler, A. Yılmaz, B. Katırcıoğlu, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1111/1755-0998.70032 (Molecular Ecology Resources 25(8): e70032)

Out-of-Anatolia: Cultural and Genetic Interactions during the Neolithic Expansion in the Aegean June 2025
D. Koptekin, A. Aydoğan, C. Karamurat, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1126/science.adr3326 (Science 388(6754): eadr3326)

Female Lineages and Changing Kinship Patterns in Neolithic Çatalhöyük June 2025
E. Yüncü, A. K. Doğu, D. Kaptan, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1126/science.adr2915 (Science 388(6754): eadr2915)

Demographic History of Early Centralized Societies: A Biodistance Study on Prehistoric Anatolia June 2025
D. Delibaş, **N. E. Altınışık**, M. A. Pilloud, M. M. Koruyucu, Y. S. Erdal
10.1016/j.jasrep.2025.105101 (Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports 64: 105101)

Pre-processing of Paleogenomes: Mitigating Reference Bias and Postmortem Damage in Ancient Genome Data Jan 2025
D. Koptekin, E. Yapar, K. B. Vural, E. Sağlıcan, **N. E. Altınışık**, A. Malaspinas, C. Alkan, M. Somel
10.1186/s13059-024-03462-w (Genome Biology 26(1): 6)

The First Complete Genome of the Extinct European Wild Ass (*Equus hemionus hydruntinus*) July 2024
M. Özkan, K. Gürün, E. Yüncü, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1111/mec.17440 (Molecular Ecology 33(14): e17440)

Benchmarking Kinship Estimation Tools for Ancient Genomes Using Pedigree Simulations July 2024
Ş. Aktürk, I. Mapelli, M. N. Güler, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1111/1755-0998.13960 (Molecular Ecology Resources 24(5): e13960)

Archaeology Meets Environmental Genomics: Implementing sedaDNA in the Study of the Human Past June 2024
K. T. Özdoğan, P. Gelabert, N. Hammers, **N. E. Altınışık**, A. de Groot, G. Plets
10.1007/s12520-024-01999-2 (Archaeological and Anthropological Sciences 16(7): 108)

Population Genomic History of the Endangered Anatolian and Cyprian Mouflons in Relation to Worldwide Wild, Feral, and Domestic Sheep Lineages May 2024
G. Atağ, D. Kaptan, E. Yüncü, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1093/gbe/evae090 (Genome Biology and Evolution 16(5): evae090)

aMeta: An Accurate and Memory-Efficient Ancient Metagenomic Profiling Workflow Oct 2023
Z. Pochon, N. Bergfeldt, E. Kırdök, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, N. Oskolkov
10.1186/s13059-023-03083-9 (Genome Biology 24(1): 242)

Spatial and Temporal Heterogeneity in Human Mobility Patterns in Holocene Southwest Asia and the East Mediterranean Jan 2023
D. Koptekin, E. Yüncü, R. Rodríguez-Varela, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1016/j.cub.2022.11.034 (Current Biology 33(1): 41–57.e15)

Indian Genetic Heritage in Southeast Asian Populations Feb 2022
P. Changmai, K. Jaisamut, J. Kampuansai, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, P. Flegontov
10.1371/journal.pgen.1010036 (PLOS Genetics 18(2): e1010036)

Collaborate Equitably in Ancient DNA Research and Beyond Dec 2021
M. Somel, **N. E. Altınışık**, F. Özer, M. C. Ávila-Arcos
10.1038/d41586-021-03541-z (Nature 600(7887): 37)

Archaeogenetic Analysis of Neolithic Sheep from Anatolia Suggests a Complex Demographic History since Domestication Nov 2021
E. Yurtman, O. Özer, E. Yüncü, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, F. Özer
10.1038/s42003-021-02794-8 (Communications Biology 4(1): 1279)

Human Inbreeding Has Decreased in Time through the Holocene Sept 2021
F. C. Ceballos, K. Gürün, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1016/j.cub.2021.06.027 (Current Biology 31(17): 3925–3934.e8)

Variable Kinship Patterns in Neolithic Anatolia Revealed by Ancient Genomes June 2021
R. Yaka, I. Mapelli, D. Kaptan, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1016/j.cub.2021.03.050 (Current Biology 31(11): 2455–2468.e18)

Palaeo-Eskimo Genetic Ancestry and the Peopling of Chukotka and North America June 2019
P. Flegontov, **N. E. Altınışık**, P. Changmai, …, S. Schiffels
10.1038/s41586-019-1251-y (Nature 570(7760): 236–240)

Archaeogenomic Analysis of the First Steps of Neolithization in Anatolia and the Aegean Nov 2017
G. M. Kılınç, D. Koptekin, Ç. Atakuman, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
10.1098/rspb.2017.2064 (Proceedings of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences 284(1867): 20172064)

Genomic Study of the Ket: A Paleo-Eskimo-Related Ethnic Group with Significant Ancient North Eurasian Ancestry Feb 2016
P. Flegontov, P. Changmai, A. Zidkova, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, T. V. Tatarinova
10.1038/srep20768 (Scientific Reports 6(1): 20768)

Book Chapters

Unveiling the Population Dynamics of the Urartian Kingdom: Integrating Genetic and Archaeological Evidence 2026
N. E. Altınışık, F. Özer, Y. S. Erdal
10.1484/M.ARAXES-EB.5.151056 (In: M. Işıklı, R. Çavuşoğlu, H. Ocak, D. Demirtaş, A. Aslan, J. Bailey (eds.), Urartu and Beyond: Improvement and Interaction in the Iron Age Highlands. Antwerp: Brepols, pp. 277–290)

Datings 2026
N. E. Altınışık, E. Özdoğan
(In: E. Özdoğan, S. Hansen, M. Özdoğan (eds.), Aşağı Pınar III. Layer 7 – The Earliest Phase of Neolithic Aşağı Pınar and the Problem of the Ditches. Bonn: Dr. Rudolf Habelt, pp. 21–30)

A Genomic History of the Neolithisation in Anatolia: Preliminary Insights 2024
A. Aydoğan, **N. E. Altınışık**, H. C. Gemici, Ç. Atakuman, F. Özer, M. Somel
(In: B. Irvine, Y. S. Erdal, L. Vandeput (eds.), People of Anatolia: Past, Current and Future Research in the Biological Anthropology of Türkiye. London: British Institute at Ankara, pp. 70–80)

From Bones to Genomes: Current Research on the Population History of Prehistoric Anatolia 2021
D. D. Kazancı, **N. E. Altınışık**, A. Aydoğan, F. Özer, E. Sürer, Ç. Atakuman, M. Somel
(In: S. R. Steadman, G. McMahon (eds.), The Archaeology of Anatolia, Volume IV: Recent Discoveries (2018–2020). Cambridge: Cambridge Scholars Publishing, pp. 355–371)

Ancient Genomics in Neolithic Central Anatolia and Çatalhöyük 2021
R. Yaka, A. Doğu, D. Kaptan, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …, M. Somel
(In: I. Hodder (ed.), Peopling the Landscape of Çatalhöyük: Reports from the 2009–2017 Seasons. London: British Institute at Ankara, pp. 1–11)

Supervision

Dr. Duygu Deniz Kazancı 2025 – 2027
Post-Doc Academic Advisor · Investigation of Ancient Human DNA Preservation from Different Eras in Anatolia · TÜBİTAK 2218 National Postdoctoral Research Fellowship Programme

Utku Bora Döke 2025 – present
MSc Thesis Advisor · Machine Learning Classification of Kinship Type from Degraded Genomic Data Using Identity-by-Descent and Runs-of-Homozygosity Segments

Elifnaz Eker 2022 – 2025
MSc Thesis Co-Advisor · Demographic and Kinship Analysis of the Roman Empire in the Anatolian Peninsula

Arda Sevkar 2020 – 2023
MSc Thesis Co-Advisor · Analysis of *Mycobacterium leprae* in Leprosy-Affected Individuals from Medieval to Late Ottoman Anatolia Using Ancient DNA Methods

Teaching

Digital Humanities Hacettepe University
Graduate course (MSc) 2026 – present

Bioarchaeology of Human Mobility and Social Structures in Ancient Societies Hacettepe University
Graduate course (PhD) 2025 – present

Data Analysis in Anthropology Hacettepe University
Graduate course (MSc) 2025 – present

Applied Statistics in Anthropology — Hacettepe University
Undergraduate elective course — 2024 – present

Population Genetics — Hacettepe University
Undergraduate course, Department of Anthropology — 2021 – present

Introduction to Anthropology — Hacettepe University
Undergraduate elective course — 2021 – 2025

Human Biological Diversity — Hacettepe University
Undergraduate course, Department of Anthropology — 2020 – present

Conference Presentations

A Diachronic Paleogenomic Analysis of Consanguinity from the Iron Age to the Early Middle Ages in the Roman World — June 2026
N. E. Altınışık
(SMBE 2026, Copenhagen, Denmark)

Scientist as a Citizen-Subject in a Collapsing Habitat — June 2026
N. E. Altınışık
(SMBE 2026, Copenhagen, Denmark)

Unearthing Family Ties: An Ancient Genomic Odyssey Through Western Eurasia — Aug 2024
N. E. Altınışık, K. B. Vural
(30th Annual Meeting of the European Association of Archaeologists (EAA), Rome, Italy)

Geç Antik Dönemde Melitene'de (Malatya) Genetik Çeşitlilik ve Popülasyon Dinamikleri [Genetic Diversity and Population Dynamics in Late Antique Melitene (Malatya)] — May 2024
N. E. Altınışık
(44th International Symposium of Excavations, Surveys and Archaeometry, Nevşehir, Türkiye)

Human Mobility in the First Millennium AD of Asia Minor: An Archaeogenomic Approach — Mar 2024
N. E. Altınışık
(93rd Annual Meeting of the American Association of Biological Anthropologists, Los Angeles, CA, USA)

İnsan Hareketliliğinin İzleri: Roma İmparatorluğu'nda Popülasyon Yapısı [Traces of Human Mobility: Population Structure in the Roman Empire] — Oct 2023
N. E. Altınışık
(8th Biological Anthropology Symposium, Ankara, Türkiye)

New Insights into the Population Structure of Pre-Pottery Neolithic Upper Mesopotamia — July 2023
N. E. Altınışık, E. Yüncü, D. D. Kazancı, K. B. Vural, Ö. D. Erdal, F. Özer, …
(SMBE 2023, Ferrara, Italy)

Intramural Burials in Neolithic Anatolia: What Do They Tell about Social Organisation — Oct 2022
M. Somel, **N. E. Altınışık**, Y. S. Erdal, Ç. Atakuman, F. Özer
(Kinship, Sex, and Biological Relatedness: The Contribution of Archaeogenetics to the Understanding of Social and Biological Relations, Halle (Saale), Germany. Proceedings paper, pp. 137–148)

A Comparative Analysis on Ancient Genomic Data: The Impact of Variant Discovery Approach on Population Genetics Tests — Oct 2022
İ. Taç, U. Işıldak, H. Çubukcu, D. Karadavut, K. B. Vural, **N. E. Altınışık**, …
(15th International Symposium on Health Informatics and Bioinformatics (HIBIT 2022), Mersin, Türkiye)

Neolitik Çağdan Tunç Çağına Güney Kafkasya Nüfus Tarihi ve Anadolu Yarımadası ile Uzun Dönemli Etkileşimleri [Population History of the South Caucasus from the Neolithic to the Bronze Age and Its Long-Term Interactions with Anatolia] — Sept 2022
N. E. Altınışık, F. Özer, A. Sevkar, M. Somel, Y. S. Erdal
(Urartu and Beyond Symposium, Van, Türkiye)

Neolitik Dönem Yukarı Mezopotamya Tarihine Antik DNA Perspektifinden Bir Bakış: Çayönü Tepesi'nden İlk Genomik Bulgular [An Ancient DNA Perspective on Neolithic Upper Mesopotamia: First Genomic Findings from Çayönü Tepesi] — May 2022
N. E. Altınışık
(42nd International Symposium of Excavations, Surveys and Archaeometry, Denizli, Türkiye)

Biological Justification of Stratification: Race and Other Dimensions of Rank Order — Aug 2021
G. Akbay, **N. E. Altınışık**, M. Somel
(Philosophy and History of Race Workshop (online))

First Genomic Insights into the Pre-Pottery Neolithic of Upper Mesopotamia June 2021
N. E. Altınışık, A. Aydoğan, D. D. Kazancı, K. B. Vural, D. Koptekin, M. Özkan, …
(9th International Symposium on Biomolecular Archaeology (ISBA9), Toulouse, France)

Benchmarking Kinship Estimation Tools for Ancient Genomes Using Pedigree Simulations Oct 2020
M. Çetin, Ş. Aktürk, I. Mapelli, R. Yaka, S. Çokoğlu, D. Zakaria, …, **N. E. Altınışık**, …
(13th International Symposium on Health Informatics and Bioinformatics (HIBIT 2020), Istanbul, Türkiye)

Traces of Human Adaptive Evolution in the Mediterranean Region Oct 2020
F. R. Fidan, E. Fer, **N. E. Altınışık**, Ö. Gökçümen, M. Somel
(International Symposium on Health Informatics and Bioinformatics (HIBIT 2020), Istanbul, Türkiye)

Kuzey Amerika ve Kuzeydoğu Asya Halklarının İlişkisinin Genomik Açıdan İncelenmesi [A Genomic Investigation of the Relationship between the Peoples of North America and Northeast Asia] Oct 2019
N. E. Altınışık, P. Flegontov, P. Changmai, S. Schiffels
(7th Biological Anthropology Symposium, Ankara, Türkiye)

Tracing the Origin and Expansion of the Turkic and Hunnic Confederations Sept 2018
P. Flegontov, **N. E. Altınışık**, C. Jeong, S. Schiffels, …
(8th International Symposium on Biomolecular Archaeology (ISBA8), Jena, Germany)

Indian Genetic Heritage in Southeast Asian Populations Sept 2018
P. Changmai, **N. E. Altınışık**, E. Yüncü, O. Flegontova, J. Kampuansai, W. Kutanan, …
(8th International Symposium on Biomolecular Archaeology (ISBA8), Jena, Germany)

Comparing Alternative Hypotheses on the Peopling of the American Arctic Aug 2018
N. E. Altınışık, P. Changmai, D. Reich, S. Schiffels, P. Flegontov
(2nd Joint Congress on Evolutionary Biology, Montpellier, France)

Modelling the Origin and Expansion of Turkic Speakers July 2018
N. E. Altınışık, P. Flegontov
(Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Symposium Turkey, İzmir, Türkiye)

A New Model for the Peopling of the American Arctic July 2017
N. E. Altınışık, P. Flegontov
(Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Symposium Turkey, Istanbul, Türkiye)

Rare Variants and Autosomal Haplotypes Reveal the Siberian Roots of North American Na-Dene Populations Dec 2016
P. Flegontov, **N. E. Altınışık**, P. Changmai, E. J. Vajda, J. Krause, S. Schiffels
(DNA Polymorphisms in Human Populations, Paris, France)

Languages

Turkish: Native

English: Fluent